**E-BUY, REQUEST RFP#1834457**

***Document Management Services for the CAFE Program***

**VENDOR QUESTION AND GOVERNMENT RESPONSES**

**Questions Due**: **12:00 PM EST Thursday, September 3, 2026**

| No. | Section | Questions | Government Response |
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| **1** | RFQ §L.8.1.1 (p. 45) | The technical proposal instructions require that Offerors submit (as part of the technical approach): (1) MS Word versions of the 2024 FRM TSD and 2025 NPRM TSD PDFs (which are linked in the amended RFQ), and (2) a MS Word redline comparison of the 2024 TSD and the 2025 TSD. Will the Government confirm that these three documents can be provided as separate technical proposal attachments? Each of these documents will be several hundred pages long. Will the Government confirm that these three documents can be converted and compressed into PDF files, given that the MS Word file size may be prohibitively large to transmit via email? If email attachment size is an issue that prevents an offeror from including these technical proposal attachments in a single email, will the Government confirm that an offeror may send these attachment submissions as separate emails and break apart the documents into separate attachments, as needed, for purposes of email transmission? Each email will indicate the RFP number and total number of emails being submitted. For example, "RFP #1834457 Email 1 of 3. Etc." | *To limit the number of emails and attachments, only conduct the assessment to the first two chapters of the documents. First, convert the documents into word. Create a new document with only first two chapters of each document (TSD, RIA and Preamble). Then conduct the requested assessment.*<br><br>*This will create smaller versions of each document to a limited number of emails.* |

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| **2** | RFQ §B.5 (Price Schedule) | Can Offerors propose additional labor categories (beyond those listed in RFQ Section B.4 and in the price schedule tables in Section B.5), provided that these additional labor categories appear in the bidder's GSA Schedule? | *Yes, we anticipate that there will be labor categories based on the vendors company and size.* |
| **3** | RFQ §§B.5 (Price Schedule) and L.9 (Volume II – Cost/Business Quote Instructions) | Will the Government confirm that an offeror's price quote submission should be limited to populating rates for labor categories listed in the B.5 price schedule tables? | *The vendor is required to use the labor categories specified in the RFP. However, vendors may propose equivalent internal job titles, provided that the associated labor descriptions are substantially similar to those listed in the RFP* |
| **4** | RFQ §L.8 (Volume I – Technical Proposal) | Will the Government confirm that 10 point font is acceptable for tables? The RFQ indicates that fonts smaller than 12-point "are acceptable for pictures, graphics, etc." | *Yes, however NHTSA will provide style guides based on the latest guidance from policy makers and regulations.* |
| **5** | RFQ §L.8 (Volume I – Technical Proposal) | Will the Government please confirm that offerors may use a title page and cover letter in both volumes (and does not count against the page limit)? | *Yes, confirming.* |
| **6** | RFQ §L.8 (Volume I – Technical Proposal) | Would the Government consider excluding tables from the 25-page limit for Volume I? The RFQ indicates that the 25-page limit excludes only "table of contents graphs or pictures with text, and resumes." | *Yes, confirming.* |
| **7** | RFQ §L.8.1.2 (Part IV: Qualifications of Project Personnel (Factor 2)) | Would the Government confirm that the letters of commitment required for subcontractor personnel/consultants can be included as an appendix to Volume I or on unnumbered pages within the technical quote, not counting towards the 25-page limit? | *Yes, confirming.* |
| **8** | RFQ §L.8.1.3 (Part III: Corporate Experience and Past Performance (Factor 3)) | The RFQ states "Offerors also shall list all contracts – regardless of dollar value and subject matter – that were terminated for default or convenience by the Federal government within the past three years." Would the | *Yes, confirming.* |

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| | | Government allow offerors to include this list of contracts as an appendix to Volume I or on unnumbered page(s) within the technical quote, not counting towards the 25-page limit? | |
| **9** | RFQ §L.8.1.3 (Part III: Corporate Experience and Past Performance (Factor 3)) | The RFQ states "Offerors also shall list all contracts – regardless of dollar value and subject matter – that were terminated for default or convenience by the Federal government within the past three years." Will NHTSA revise the RFQ to require only that Offerors list any contracts that were terminated for default (rather than also listing contracts that were terminated for convenience)? | *No, list all terminations.* |
| **10** | RFQ §L.10 (Disclosure of Conflict of Interest) | Would the Government confirm that the Offeror's conflict of interest statement can be included as an appendix to Volume I or on unnumbered pages within the technical quote, not counting towards the 25-page limit? | *Yes, confirming.* |
| **11** | RFQ §L.10 (Disclosure of Conflict of Interest) | Would the Government confirm the current incumbent contractor and contract number? | *The incumbent is:*<br>*Federal Miracle Tech*<br>*GREENBELT MD 207706523*<br>*7701 GREENBELT RD STE 501* |
| **12** | RFQ §C.3 (RFP body) vs. posted Draft SOW §C.3 | The RFP body (§C.3) states rulemaking document sizes "range from 150 pages to 1,500 pages," while the separately posted Draft SOW states documents "range from 150 pages to 5,000 pages." Which range is authoritative for sizing the technical approach and level of effort? | *150 to 1500 is more accurate. In the past the length has been up to the 5000 pages, we expect rulemaking documents to be in the 150-1500 range going forward.* |
| **13** | RFQ §B.5 and §C.1 | The B.5 Price Schedule reflects a fixed estimated level of effort of 3,610 labor hours per period (identical across the base and both option years), while §C.1 states effort "will vary widely" and may require evenings, weekends, or overnight support at peak. Will the | *The 3610 hours is for pricing only for max amount, and we expect that to vary depending on the rulemaking effort. This was the total hours of efforts from average of past few rulemakings* |

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| | | Government confirm whether the 3,610 hours are a not-to-exceed ceiling or a Government estimate for pricing only, and whether offerors may propose a different hour mix across labor categories? | |
| **14** | RFQ §B.3.5 (Overtime) and §C.1 | Given the anticipated evening/weekend/overnight peak support, does the Government expect offerors to include overtime premiums for non-exempt staff within the estimated hours, or will overtime be separately authorized and funded by the Contracting Officer at time of need? | *The evening/weekend/overnight peak is for only limited time rather continuously throughout the year. This should be part of the contractor's total price estimate based on the 3610 hours.* |
| **15** | RFQ §C.4(2) vs. §C.5.3 | §C.4(2) states the contractor "should have SharePoint or Google Drive hosting and managing capability," while §C.5.3 states the contractor "will be provided access to a NHTSA SharePoint site and/or shared drive." Will the Government confirm whether document storage and version control occur within NHTSA's Government-furnished SharePoint/Google environment, or whether the contractor must host and maintain its own environment? | *The contractor must host and maintain its own environment. We may provide access for limited time to pull documents from NHTSA sharepoint, but it will not be the main sharepoint for majority of the effort.* |
| **16** | RFQ §H.3 (GFP) and §H.2 | Will NHTSA furnish Government equipment (e.g., laptops) and system credentials to contractor staff given the DOT/NHTSA IT security, HSPD-12, and network-access requirements, or must the contractor provide its own equipment configured to DOT standards? | *No, government will not furnish equipment. Vendors are expected to have systems in place.* |
| **17** | RFQ §C.5.1 / §F.3.1 vs. Draft SOW | The RFP requires the kickoff meeting "within 10 days after award" (§F.3.1 states 10 business days), while the Draft SOW states "within 3 days." Please confirm the 10-business-day requirement governs. | *Confirming within 10 business days.* |
| **18** | RFQ §C.4(8) | The SOW states "each task order for document | *This may be multiple rulemaking with multiple* |

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| | | management will be for a specific rulemaking action." Will the Government clarify whether this award is a single Task Order supporting one rulemaking action at a time, or whether multiple concurrent rulemaking actions may be directed within the estimated annual level of effort? | *documents within each rulemaking. This is the reason we have estimated 3610 hours for the whole contract that vendor should use to assess their costs.* |
| **19** | RFQ §F.6 (Section 508) | For rulemaking documents up to several thousand pages, will the Government confirm the extent of the contractor's Section 508 responsibility (e.g., full remediation such as tagging, alt-text, and accessible tables) versus formatting only, with NHTSA performing final accessibility compliance? | *NHTSA will provide Section 508 compliance requirements and guidance for the contractor to fulfill as part of its responsibilities. NHTSA will work with the contractor for final compliance at the end of rulemaking.* |
| **20** | RFQ §K.2(a)(1) vs. §L.2 | §K.2(a)(1) identifies NAICS 541611 as "Research and Development in the Social Sciences and Humanities," while §L.2 identifies 541611 as "Administrative Management and General Management Consulting Services." Please confirm the correct NAICS title and the applicable small business size standard. | *Confirming that it's 541611 as "Administrative Management and General Management Consulting Services.* |
| **21** | RFQ §L.8.1.1 | The instruction directs offerors to download the 2024 FRM TSD and 2025 NPRM TSD "from here," but the hyperlinks do not appear in the posted RFQ text. Will the Government provide the exact URLs (or post the source PDFs as attachments) for the required TSD conversion and redline demonstration? | *The links below provides examples of past NHTSA rulemaking activities, including the three major document types as well as their corresponding Office of the Federal Register versions. Because these documents undergo various review processes with staff and leadership, contractors must ensure all edits and style guide requirements are incorporated.*<br>• *Analysis*<br>• *Draft Technical Support Document*<br>• *Notice of Proposed Rulemaking* |

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| | | | • *Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFE) \| NHTSA* |
| **22** | RFQ §L.8.1.1 / §L.8 | Will the Government confirm that the required TSD Word conversions and redline comparison are demonstration deliverables submitted as separate attachments that do not count against the 25-page Volume I limit? | *Yes, confirming it does not count against the 25 pages.* |
| **23** | RFQ §L.8 | §L.8 permits submission in "PDF, Microsoft Word, EXCEL," while the same section states electronic submissions shall be "compatible with standard Government office productivity software (e.g., Google Workspace or equivalent)." Please confirm PDF and Microsoft Word/Excel submissions are acceptable. | *This is confirmed; however, please note that DOT policy remains in flux and subject to change.* |
| **24** | RFQ §L.8.1.3 and §L.5 | Past Performance Questionnaires (Attachment J.1) are due at the same date/time as the proposal (2:00 PM EST, September 8, 2026). Because references require lead time, will the Government accept PPQs submitted directly by references after the proposal due date, and confirm that a late PPQ will not render an otherwise timely and compliant proposal noncompliant? | *Proposals and Past Performance Questionnaires are due 2:00 PM EST, September 8, 2026.* |
| **25** | RFQ §L.8.1.3 | Will the Government confirm whether the two (2) CPARS references are in addition to the three (3) recommended references, and whether the reference lists, CPARS, and the terminated-contracts list may be provided as appendices excluded from the 25-page limit? | *Yes, confirming it does not count towards 25 pages.* |
| **26** | RFQ §L.9 | Please confirm Volume II (Cost/Business Quote) has no page limit and is not subject to the 25-page Volume I technical limit. | *Yes, confirming it does not count towards 25 pages; and does not have a page limit.* |

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| | | | *Volume II (Cost/Business Quote) does not have a page limit.* |
| **27** | RFQ §M.2 and §M.6 | §M.2 describes a two-phase process (technical acceptability, then cost), while §M.6 lists three technical factors "in descending order of importance." Will the Government clarify whether the technical factors are evaluated on an acceptable/unacceptable basis or assigned adjectival/color ratings, and what rating scale will be used? | *All technical factors combined are significantly more important than price.* |
| **28** | RFQ §M.3 / §M.4 | Please confirm the award is a best-value tradeoff in which the combined technical factors are more important than cost, and clarify how the "descending order of importance" among Factors 1–3 will be applied in the tradeoff. | *Confirming award is a best value.* |
| **29** | RFQ §M.6.1 and §L.8.1.1 | Will the Government confirm whether, and how, the TSD conversion/redline demonstration is scored under Factor 1 (e.g., pass/fail versus a qualitative assessment of formatting accuracy)? | *The request is a simple pass/fail demonstration.* |
| **30** | RFQ §M.6.3 | For offerors without a historical past performance record that will be "only rated on Corporate Experience," please confirm this equates to a neutral/unknown past performance determination consistent with FAR 15.305(a)(2)(iv) and will not be scored unfavorably. | *Confirming that the Agency will consider offerors without past historical performance consistent with FAR 15.305(a)(2)(iv).* |
| ***Extension Request*** | | | |
| **31** | RFQ §L.1 and §L.5 | Questions are due 12:00 PM EST Thursday, September 3, 2026, and proposals are due 2:00 PM EST Tuesday, September 8, 2026. With the intervening Friday (September 4), the weekend, and the Federal Labor Day holiday (Monday, September 7, 2026), offerors will have effectively one business day between receipt of | *The deadline will not be extended.* |

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| | | the Government's Q&A responses and the proposal deadline. Given the substantive Factor 1 demonstration (converting and redlining several-hundred-page TSDs) and the need to coordinate reference PPQs, will the Government extend the proposal due date by at least three (3) business days (e.g., to on or about Friday, September 11, 2026) following issuance of the Q&A responses? | |
| **32** | G.7 KEY PERSONNEL | Section G.7 identifies only the Project Manager as key personnel; however, Section L.8.1.2 requires resumes for all proposed staff. Can the Government clarify whether resumes are required for all proposed personnel or only for the Project Manager identified as key personnel? | *Only proposed key personnel is required* |
| **33** | J.2 ATTACHMENT PAST PERFORMANCE QUESTIONNAIRE | May Past Performance Questionnaires (PPQs) previously submitted by our CORs for an earlier proposal be reused and considered for this solicitation, or are updated PPQs required? | *No.* |
| **34** | L.9 VOLUME II - COST/BUSINESS QUOTE INSTRUCTIONS | Should vendors propose their own estimated labor hours for contract performance, or should the hours provided by the Government in the solicitation be used as the basis for pricing? | *The hours provided by the government should be used as the basis for pricing not to exceed.* |
| **35** | L.8.1.1 PART III: TECHNICAL APPROACH (Factor 1) | May vendors provide the document comparison deliverables through a secure SharePoint or OneDrive link if file sizes exceed email limitations? | *Yes.* |
| **36** | B.5 PRICE SCHEDULE | Are the labor-hour estimates provided in Section B based on historical incumbent performance or projected future workload requirements? | *The 3610 hours is for pricing only for maximum amount, and we expect that to vary depending on the rulemaking effort. This was the total hours of efforts from average of past few rulemakings.* |
| **37** | C.1 INTRODUCTION | Can the Government provide historical information regarding after-hours, weekend, and | *In very few instances, due to the timeline of rulemaking efforts to meet regulatory deadlines we* |

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| | | overnight support requirements? | *may ask for quick turn around of finalized documents for publications. These are only in few instances in a given year.* |
| **38** | C.1 INTRODUCTION | What is the average and maximum number of concurrent rulemaking efforts anticipated during a performance year? | *There is the maximum number of rules at the same time, but average between 1 to 2 currently.* |
| **39** | SECTION K – REPRESENTATION, CERTIFICATIONS AND OTHER STATEMENTS OF OFFERORS | In which volume should vendors include the Reps and Certs and other statements of offerors? | *VOLUME II - COST/BUSINESS QUOTE INSTRUCTIONS* |
| **40** | L.9 VOLUME II - COST/BUSINESS QUOTE INSTRUCTIONS | Please provide historical workload data for the previous three years, including the number of rulemaking actions supported annually, average document size, average number of review cycles, total contractor labor hours expended, and contractor staffing composition. | *The estimated hours provided in the RFP is an average of annual hours from the previous few years which included multiple rulemakings. The average document size varies from 150 to 1500 pages, depending on the policy directions and regulatory efforts. The average number of review cycles could be between 10 to 14 depending on topic area and complexity. The contractor should consider the hours provided and the number of labor categories provided.* |
| **41** | L.8.1.1 PART III: TECHNICAL APPROACH (Factor 1) | Can the government please elaborate what is required in the comparison analysis between 2024FRM TSD and 2025 NPRM TSD? Is the expectation to have a Word version of the 2024FRM TSD that shows in redline what was not included and/or had language altered in the 2025 NPRM TSD? | *That is correct, the final product should be a comparison version of the documents that shows what was changed and edited between the notice and final rule.* |
| **42** | L.8.1.1 PART III: TECHNICAL APPROACH (Factor 1) | Can the Government please provide the evaluation criteria, rubric, or other measurement mechanism that will be used to assess the quality and accuracy of the converted files? Additionally, can the Government clarify the standards and characteristics that will define a | *The request is a simple pass/fail demonstration.* |

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| | | successful and acceptable output from the selected contractor? | |
| **43** | L.8 VOLUME I – TECHNICAL PROPOSAL | The solicitation establishes a page limitation for Volume I. Please confirm whether tables, matrices, schedules, and charts included within the proposal narrative count toward the page limitation, or whether any of these items are excluded from the page count. | *Yes, confirming that those do not count towards page limit.* |
| **44** | L.8.1.3 PART V: CORPORATE EXPERIENCE AND PAST PERFORMANCE (Factor 3**)** | For Volume I, may detailed CPARS reports be provided in appendices that are excluded from the page limitation, or must all Past Performance information to be evaluated be included within the page-limited proposal narrative? | *Yes, confirming that those do not count towards page limit.* |